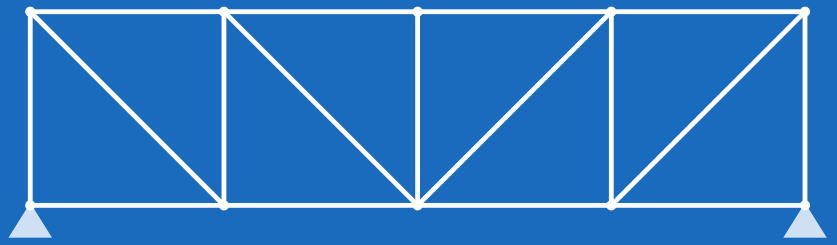
TRUSS REPORT

# Pratt truss

Plane truss — analysis and CIRSOC 301 rod checks

Author A. Student · Course Structures I · 13/10/2026



| MAX TENSION | MAX COMPRESSION | DEFLECTION | MOST USED ROD | BUCKLING $\Lambda_1$ | WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **+84.9 kN** | **-80.0 kN** | **10.2 mm** | **0.63** | **3.55** | **513 kg** |
| rod 16 | rod 6 | L/1171 · limit L/300 | rod 16 · normal stress (H.3.4) | the load can grow ×3.5 | carries 120.0 kN · 24× own weight |

## The model

| | |
|---|---|
| Span | 12.00 m |
| Height | 3.00 m |
| Nodes / rods | 10 / 17 |
| Supports | pin at 0, rollerX at 4 |
| Loads | 3 nodal, total 120.0 kN |
| Rod families | 3, with their sections: |
| Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5, F24 (CIRSOC) / A36 |
| Diagonal | CHS 60.3x3.6, F24 (CIRSOC) / A36 |
| Vertical | CHS 88.9x4.0, F24 (CIRSOC) / A36 |

## What the analysis found

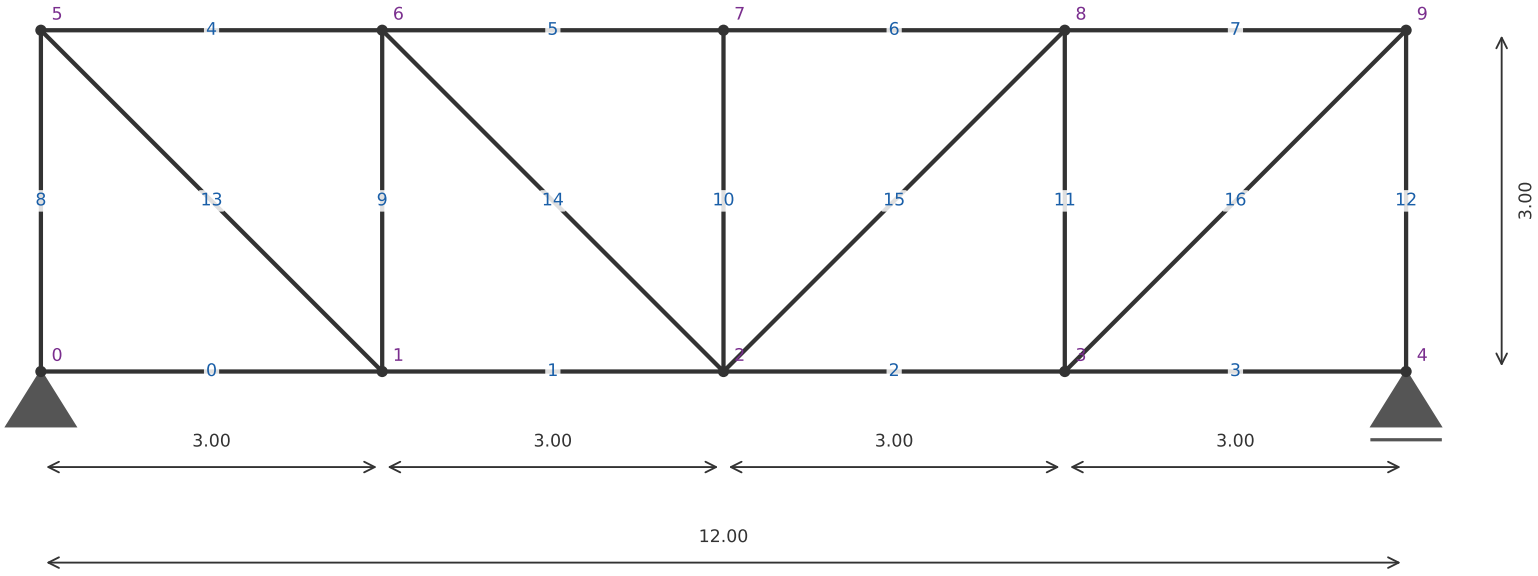
| | |
|---|---|
| Stability | Statically determinate (m + r − 2j = 17 + 3 − 2×10 = 0): statics alone gives every force. |
| Most used rod | rod 16 at 0.63 (normal stress (H.3.4)) |
| Rods over capacity | 0 of 17 checked |
| Buckling | $\lambda_1 = 3.55$ |
| Shear and moment | none: every rod is pinned and loaded only at its nodes, so the axial force is the whole result |

## Contents


2 Geometry
3 Axial forces
4 Deflection and stress
5 Reactions
6 Utilisation
7 Buckling
8 Rods
9 Explain rod 16 and 13


Results are an aid to a qualified professional, who must check them. Rod checks to CIRSOC 301 as implemented; first-order analysis; joints and connections are not checked here.

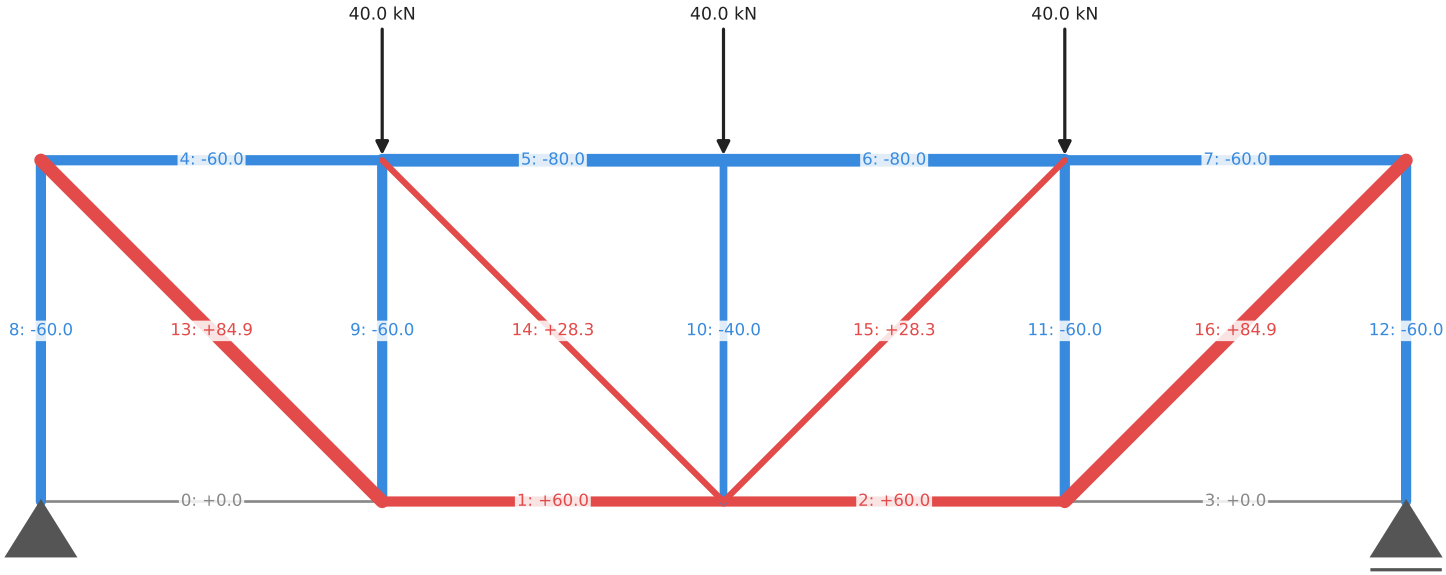
Node numbers in purple, rod numbers in blue. Dimensions in m.

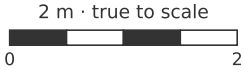



2 m · true to scale

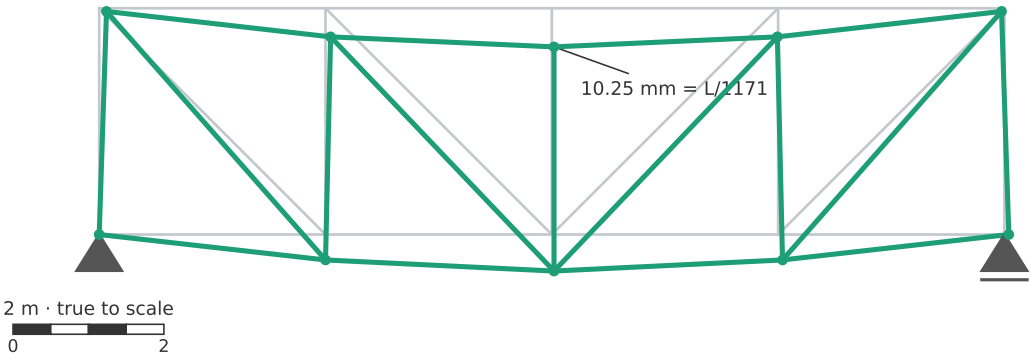
0 2

Axial force N (kN): red pulls (+), blue pushes (−), grey carries nothing; line width follows |N| (largest 84.9).



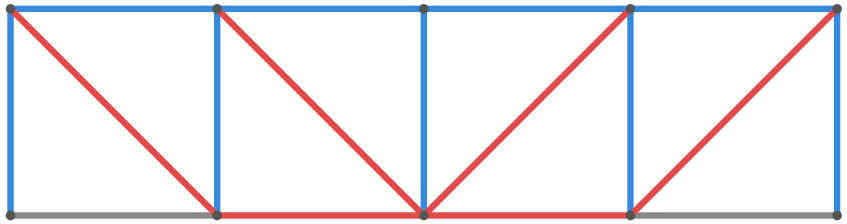



Elastic line: the deflected shape (green) over the truss (grey), every rigid rod drawn as the curve it bends into. Geometry to scale; displacements magnified × 50. Every rod is pinned, so every member stays straight: there is no curvature, and no contraflexure. Largest vertical deflection 10.25 mm against the limit L/300 = 40.0 mm: OK.

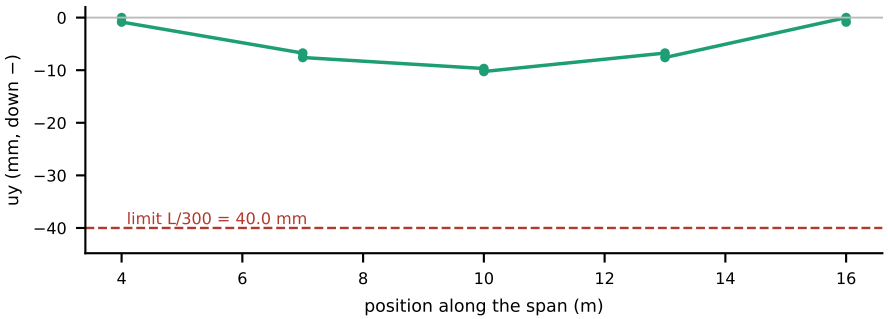



**Fibre stress** top and bottom face of each member

red = tension, blue = compression. Every rod is pinned, so both faces of a rod carry the same stress and each rod is one colour: the axial force.

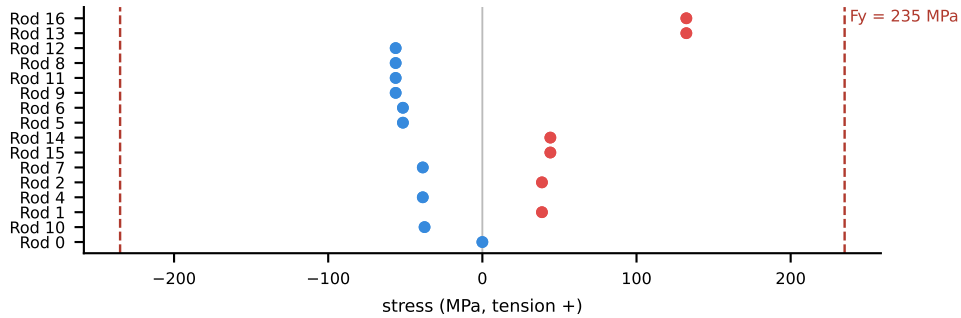


**Deflection along the span** vertical movement of every joint




Largest 10.25 mm at joint 7 = L/1171. Within the limit.

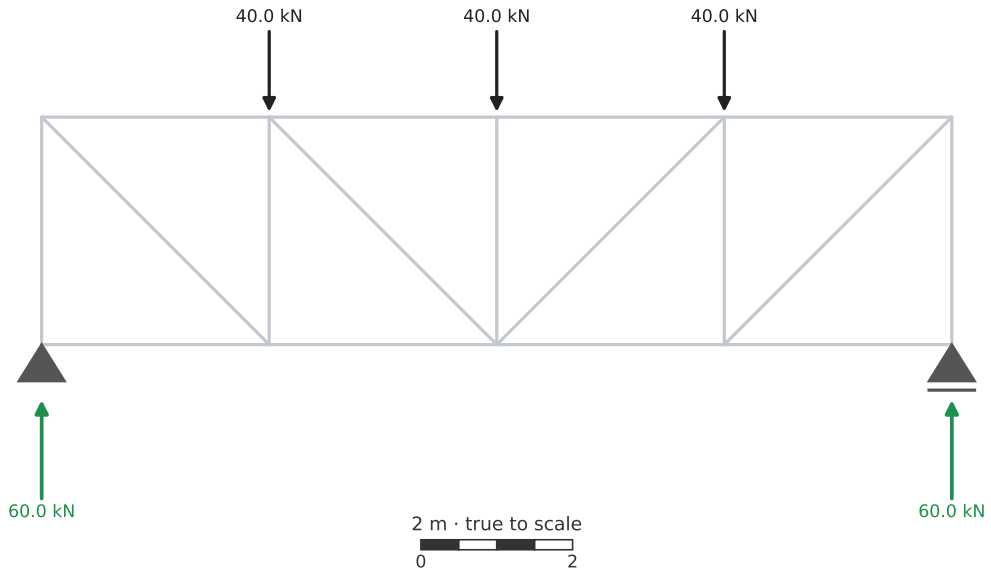
**Fibre stress values** the two faces of each rod, MPa



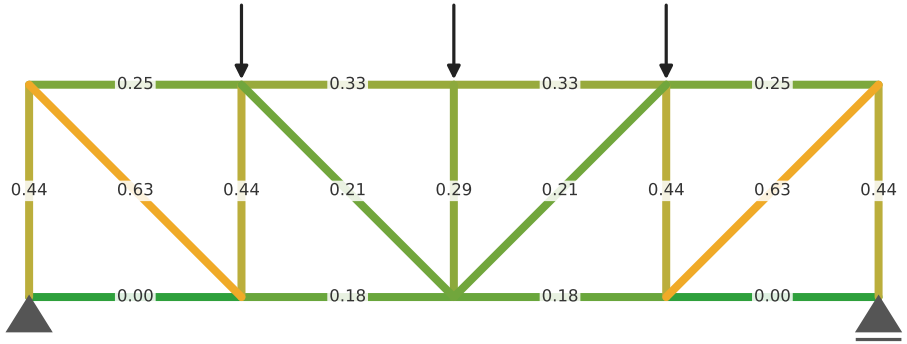

Every rod is pinned, so its two fibres carry the same N/A and coincide: no bending opens the pair.

Support reactions (green arrows), as the supports push on the truss; Ry positive upwards. The sums balance the loads.

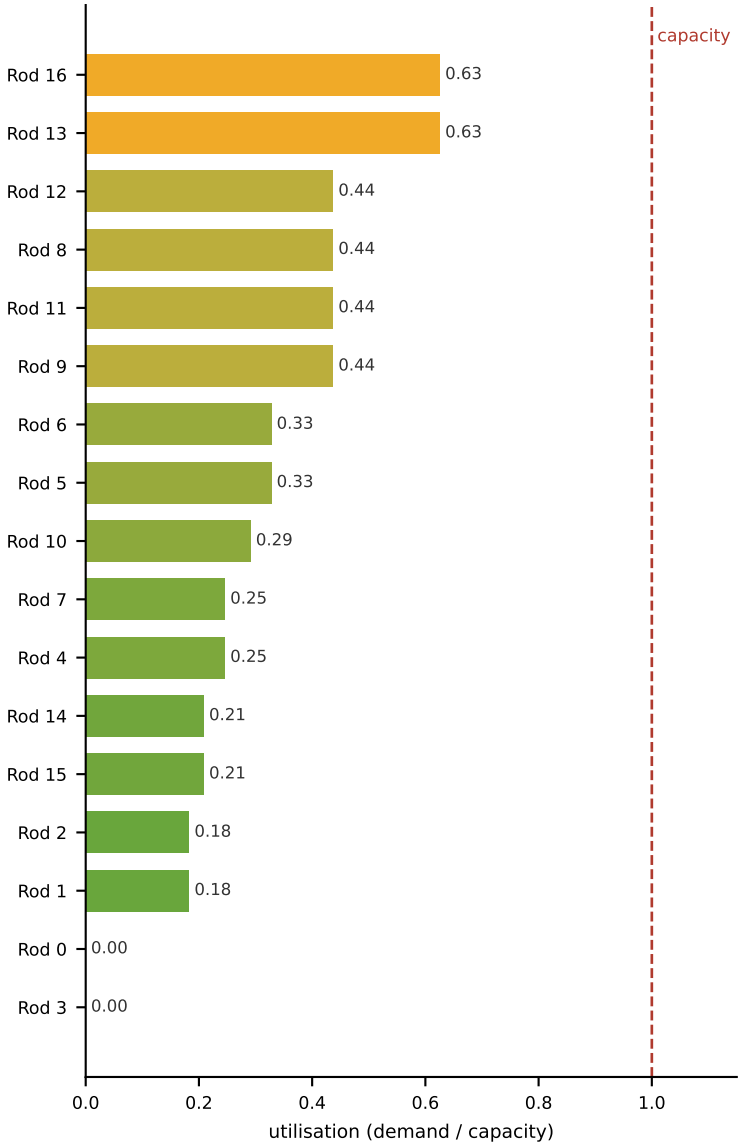
| Node | Type | Rx (kN) | Ry (kN) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | pin | 0.00 | 60.00 |
| 4 | rollerX | 0.00 | 60.00 |
| Σ | | 0.00 | 120.00 |

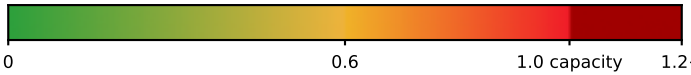


Utilisation: demand over CIRSOC 301 capacity. Most used rod 16 at 0.63 (normal stress (H.3.4)). Every checked rod is within capacity.




2 m · true to scale
0 2

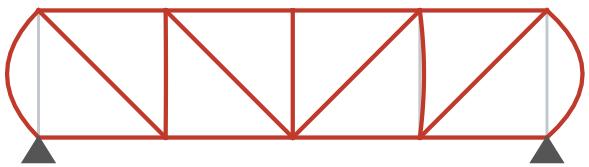


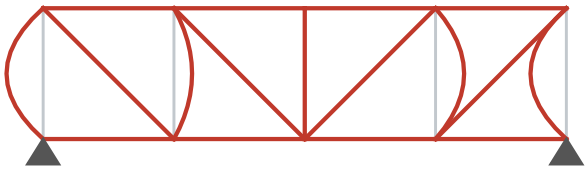

grey = no steel section, not checked

λ is the factor on the load as it stands. $\lambda_1 = 3.55$, so the load can grow 3.5× before it buckles. 3 modes share that λ: that many equal members buckle at the same load, so stiffening one of them buys nothing.

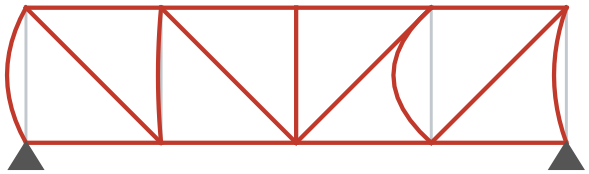
Mode 1: λ = 3.55
rod 12 bows

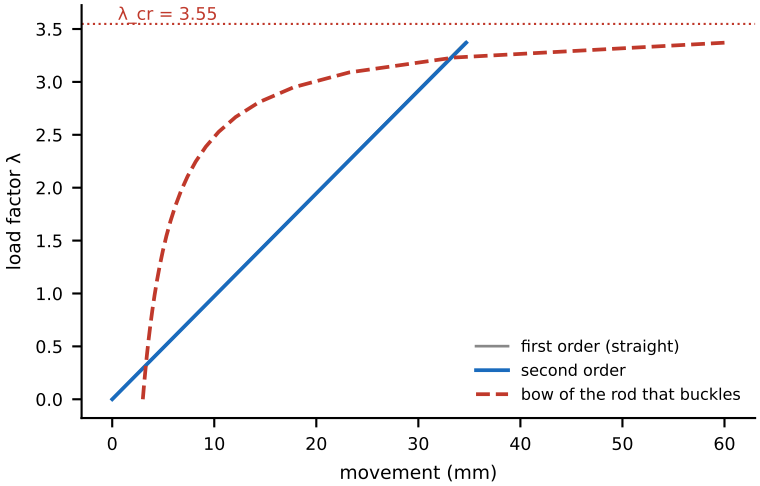


Mode 2: λ = 3.55
rod 8 bows



Mode 3: λ = 3.55
rod 11 bows



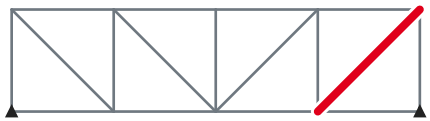



The second-order line bends away from the first-order one and runs off as λ nears λ_cr: that gap IS the amplification every second-order design rule is about. Started from an initial bow of L/1000 = 3.00 mm in the first mode's shape.

Elastic buckling of the IDEAL truss, so every λ is an UPPER bound: imperfections, residual stresses and yielding are not modelled, and each rod is cut in two so it can bow between its joints. Buckling OUT of the plane is the rod check's job (CIRSOC 301 E3, minor radius) and is in the Utilisation and Rods sheets, not here. A mode has a shape, not a size: the shapes are drawn exaggerated.

Every rod: its end nodes, family and steel section, length, axial force N (+ pulls, − pushes), the CIRSOC 301 check that governs it and how much of its capacity that uses (Use = demand / capacity; OVER above 1.0).

| Rod | Nodes | Family | Section | L (m) | N (kN) | Governing check | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 0–1 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | +0.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.00 OK |
| 1 | 1–2 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | +60.00 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.18 OK |
| 2 | 2–3 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | +60.00 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.18 OK |
| 3 | 3–4 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | +0.00 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.00 OK |
| 4 | 5–6 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | -60.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.25 OK |
| 5 | 6–7 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | -80.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.33 OK |
| 6 | 7–8 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | -80.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.33 OK |
| 7 | 8–9 | Chord | CHS 114.3x4.5 | 3.00 | -60.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.25 OK |
| 8 | 0–5 | Vertical | CHS 88.9x4.0 | 3.00 | -60.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.44 OK |
| 9 | 1–6 | Vertical | CHS 88.9x4.0 | 3.00 | -60.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.44 OK |
| 10 | 2–7 | Vertical | CHS 88.9x4.0 | 3.00 | -40.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.29 OK |
| 11 | 3–8 | Vertical | CHS 88.9x4.0 | 3.00 | -60.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.44 OK |
| 12 | 4–9 | Vertical | CHS 88.9x4.0 | 3.00 | -60.00 | inelastic buckling (E3-2) | 0.44 OK |
| 13 | 5–1 | Diagonal | CHS 60.3x3.6 | 4.24 | +84.85 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.63 OK |
| 14 | 6–2 | Diagonal | CHS 60.3x3.6 | 4.24 | +28.28 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.21 OK |
| 15 | 8–2 | Diagonal | CHS 60.3x3.6 | 4.24 | +28.28 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.21 OK |
| 16 | 9–3 | Diagonal | CHS 60.3x3.6 | 4.24 | +84.85 | normal stress (H.3.4) | 0.63 OK |



## Rod 16

utilisation 0.63

normal stress (H.3.4)

```
Rod 16
======
Steel, CIRSOC 301-2018 -- A = 641 mm², Fy = 235 MPa, L = 4.243 m

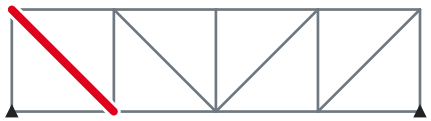
 1. Axial stress
      σ = N / A
      = 84,853 N / 641 mm²
      = 132.32 MPa

 2. Design stress  [H.3.4]
      φ · Fy
      = 0.9 × 235
      = 211.50 MPa

 3. Tension ratio  [H.3.4]
      σ / (φ Fy)
      = 132.32 / 211.50
      = 0.626

 4. Governs
      the largest ratio
      = normal stress (H.3.4)
      = 0.626

utilisation 0.626 -- OK
```



## Rod 13

utilisation 0.63

normal stress (H.3.4)

```
Rod 13
======
Steel, CIRSOC 301-2018 -- A = 641 mm², Fy = 235 MPa, L = 4.243 m

 1. Axial stress
      σ = N / A
      = 84,853 N / 641 mm²
      = 132.32 MPa

 2. Design stress  [H.3.4]
      φ · Fy
      = 0.9 × 235
      = 211.50 MPa

 3. Tension ratio  [H.3.4]
      σ / (φ Fy)
      = 132.32 / 211.50
      = 0.626

 4. Governs
      the largest ratio
      = normal stress (H.3.4)
      = 0.626

utilisation 0.626 -- OK
```